

EXPRESSION OF INTEREST · NATIONAL ROAD SAFETY BOARD

Crashfree India

**Application to Working Group 2:
Safe Roads, Speeds & Vulnerable Road Users**



Expert-guided student audits that end in built fixes, 31 sites, 7 completed



Technology the system uses: AI enforcement with police, public tracking dashboards



Published audit reports and policy research, anchored to the IRC codes



A letter to the Working Group



New Delhi · August 2026

Respected Chairperson and Members of Working Group 2,

Crashfree India is a young road safety nonprofit, registered as the Vision Zero Trust, co-founded with the Indian Road Safety Council, and backed by a three-year, US\$3 million commitment from Cars24. Our core work is road infrastructure: trained student teams audit dangerous locations under senior experts, to IRC codes and MoRTH checklists, and we walk each recommended fix through the road-owning authority until it is built, tracked on a public dashboard. MS Dhoni carries this message to the country as our Goodwill Ambassador.

In our first year we audited 31 high-risk locations across 18 cities with teams from 20 institutions, secured 25+ written approvals from road-owning authorities, and implementation has started at 15 sites, with 7 already fully built. SATARK, our AI enforcement platform, has screened over 3,00,000 vehicles for police in Jaipur and Bengaluru and has now reached Gurugram. Four open public data platforms and a national youth pipeline complete the picture.

The pages that follow introduce the organisation briefly, then set out the work most relevant to this Working Group in the detail its mandate deserves. Everything shown is running today, is public, and is offered to the Board without cost. We would be honoured to contribute.

Respectfully,

Akhtar Hussain

Mission Lead, Crashfree India · akhtar@crashfreeindia.org · crashfreeindia.org

Five sections, from who we are to what we offer

1



About us, and how we work

Who we are, our approach to the road crash crisis, and why this Working Group.

04 – 06

2



What we have built

Every public-facing programme, audits, enforcement tech, victim support, open data, youth, campaigns.

07 – 14

3



Our people

The team, its capabilities, and the expert bench around the work.

15 – 16

4



Project Rakshak in depth

The deep dive matched to this Working Group's mandate, evidence, method, results.

17 – 26

5



How we can contribute

Four concrete, no-cost offers to the Working Group.

27 – 28

Crashfree India: a nonprofit that adds **capacity** to road safety work

Registered as the Vision Zero Trust · Co-founded by Cars24 and the Indian Road Safety Council · Working since June 2025 · New Delhi

- 

Evidence first

Structured field audits, file reviews and research to official standards, not opinion.
- 

Institutional collaboration

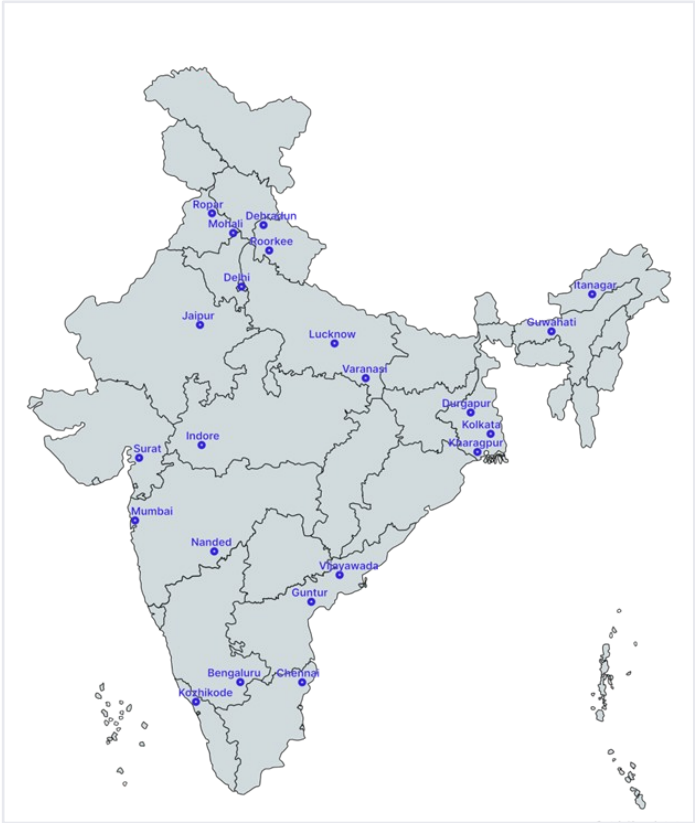
We work through PWDs, NHAI, transport departments, police and District Road Safety Committees.
- 

Youth-led capacity

Trained student teams from IITs, NITs and SPAs add the auditing hands the system needs.
- 

Technology for follow-through

Public dashboards track every recommendation from submission to completion.

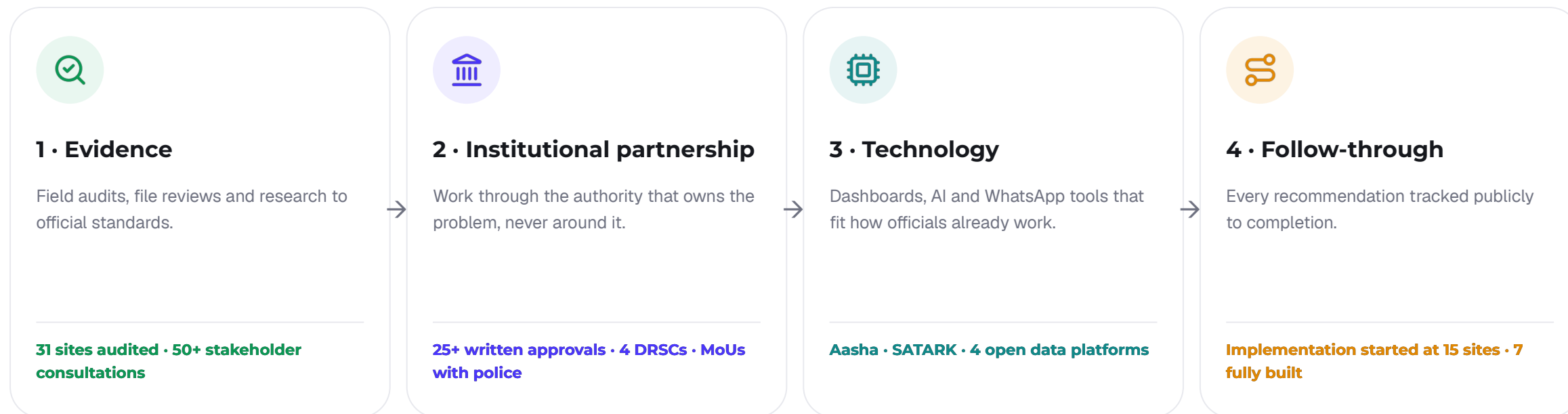


Where we work today, 18 cities, north to south.

The Group's mandate is our daily work: audits that end in built fixes, evidence for managing speeds, and streets designed around pedestrians and riders.

Our approach: work **with the system**, and prove it with data

Four steps, applied to every problem we take up, from a dangerous junction to a stalled compensation claim.



We do not replace the system and we do not campaign against it. We add hands, evidence and tools to work the system has already committed to.

Why Working Group 2, and what we bring to it

The Group's mandate matches the deepest part of our portfolio. Three focus areas where we are ready on day one.



Black-spot rectification at scale

Our audit-to-implementation pipeline is running in 18 cities, the Group's rectification agenda is our core work.



Standards for audits & speed management

Audit instruments anchored to IRC codes and MoRTH checklists, with masterclass-trained student teams.



Protecting vulnerable road users

Pedestrian-first audits, our published gig-rider safety study, school-zone screening, evidence ready for VRU standards.

EXISTING CAPABILITIES WE PUT ON THE TABLE

31 trained audit teams

Public tracking portal

District pilots: GGM · SWD · Jaipur

Gig-rider safety study

7 sites fully built

Expert bench on call

SUBJECT-MATTER EXPERTS ALREADY ENGAGED ON THIS AGENDA



Dr. Richa Ahuja
Asst Professor, IIT Kharagpur



Prof. Geetam Tiwari
TRIP Centre, IIT Delhi



Abhay Damle
Ex-Joint Secretary, MoRTH



Dipak Dash
Senior journalist, Times of India



Sarika Panda Bhatt
Co-founder & Trustee, Raahgiri Foundation

Six lines of work, one connected system

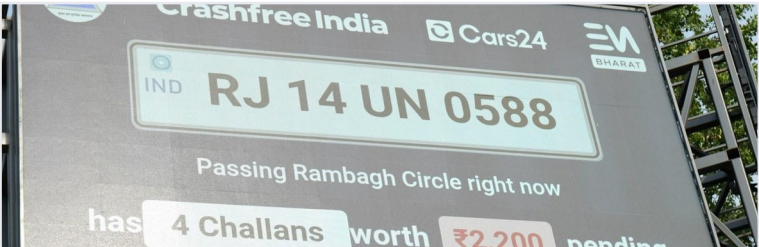
Audits create data · data supports policy · policy guides the field. Everything below is live today.



Project Rakshak

Student-led road audits, fixed with authorities

31 sites · 7 fixes fully built



SATARK enforcement

AI support that helps police find high-risk vehicles

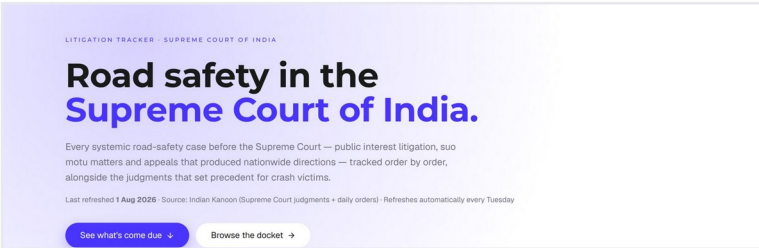
3,00,000+ vehicles screened



Victim support

Aasha chatbot, calculator, hospital helpdesks

100+ victims helped in first 4 days



Open public data

Four self-updating data platforms, free to use

36 states & 50 cities covered



Youth & policy

NextMile ideathon and national dialogue series

2,000+ participants engaged



Public campaigns

Road Safety Month with police & schools; MS Dhoni

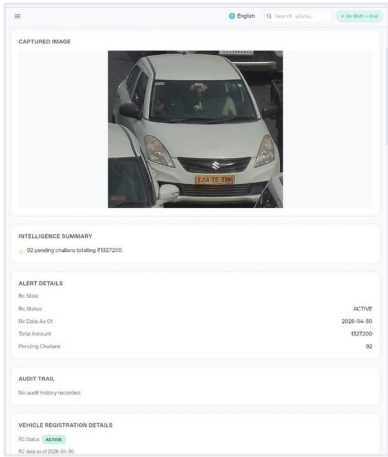
1M+ citizens reached

SATARK: AI that helps police stop the right vehicle

Built with Cars24 engineers. Reads number plates, checks government records, and alerts officers to repeat offenders, in real time.



Rambagh Circle, Jaipur, live plate, pending challans and dues on a public billboard.



Officer view, challans, RC & compliance status.

3,00,000+

vehicles screened

₹30 Cr+

pending challan value identified

350+

high-risk vehicles intercepted

70,019

vehicles found with pending challans

LIVE · Jaipur & Bengaluru

NEW · Gurugram

Bengaluru's Trinity Circle billboard was India's first, covered by Deccan Herald and national press. Pune and Ahmedabad are next.



Live public data platforms, free for any authority

Four platforms, each turning a scattered public record into structured, citable evidence. The Parliament tracker is shown live, as captured this week.

Crashfree India

A Cars24 Commitment

RTI WATCH · PARLIAMENT WATCH

A CRASHFREE INDIA PUBLIC DATABASE

Every road-safety question in Parliament since 2014.

And the MPs who never asked one.

All 1,444 Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha questions on road safety — put to the four ministries that own it: Road Transport & Highways, Health (trauma care), Heavy Industries (vehicle standards), and Housing & Urban Affairs (pedestrian safety). Reconciled against Parliament's own records so nothing is missed. Search who asks,

Road Safety in Parliament: all 1,444 questions since 2014 across four ministries; 275 of 540 sitting Lok Sabha MPs have never asked one.

National Road-Infrastructure Defect Repository

DAILY · 07:00 IST

An AI pipeline reads local-language news every morning and turns road-defect reports into structured, mapped, ranked evidence, each entry carrying its verbatim source.

Potholes

Missing signage

Unlit stretches

Blind curves

Broken dividers

146

districts scanned daily

13

languages read

21

defect codes tracked

Local news → AI extraction → confidence gate → human review → public map. Live across Bihar, UP and Rajasthan districts today.

Supreme Court Litigation Tracker

WEEKLY · LIVE

Every systemic road-safety matter before the Supreme Court, orders indexed, precedent judgments digested, refreshed every Tuesday.

18

tracked cases, 190+ orders

11

court directions overdue at launch

Crash Data Dashboard

ANNUAL · OPEN DATA

MoRTH's annual 'Road Accidents in India' books as a usable product: report cards for 36 states and 50 cities, every number reconciled against the printed books, open licence (CC-BY).

485

people killed per day (RAI 2024)

36+50

state and city report cards

From the first hours after a crash to the final compensation order, on WhatsApp, on paper, and in person.

Hospital helpdesks bring all of this to the trauma-ward bedside , 100+ victims supported in the first four days, run with DLSA and Neev Foundation.

Young talent and senior experts, working the same problem

A steady pipeline of engineers and policy minds, so road safety work never runs out of hands.



NextMile: Road Safety Policy Ideathon, grand finale, 28 Sep 2025, New Delhi.

2,000+	250+	700+	10
participants	concept notes	teams	finalist teams



National Road Safety Implementation Forum, IIT Delhi: 60+ experts from MoRTH, WHO, UNICEF, iRAP and CSIR-CRRI reviewed the work.

Mentors and jury from the Government of Rajasthan, NIUA, OMI, NASSCOM and CSEP judged the student teams; winning tracks now feed our audit and research pipeline.



National Road Safety Dialogue Series

200+ live attendees; speakers from MoRTH, CIRT, AIIMS Trauma Centre, CSIR-CRRI and ARAI.



Three sessions so far

Bus safety · Delivery rider safety · Good Samaritan law & the Cashless Treatment Scheme.



Advocacy on video

Our YouTube channel documents hazards and fixes on camera: ground-audit walkthroughs, Dialogue Series recordings and victim-education explainers. A public record any authority can cite.

Next: 'Be a Rakshak' university chapters at IITs, NITs and SPAs.

Road Safety Month 2026, run **with the system**

With district police, schools, hospitals and delivery platforms, in Hindi and local languages.



National Road Safety Month rally, on the road with district traffic police, Jan 2026.

1M+ citizens reached across campaigns in year one.



CFI stall at a government office



Materials briefing with police staff



School programme with certificates



Delivery-rider outreach, Swiggy & Instamart

MS Dhoni gives road safety a national voice



MS Dhoni, Goodwill Ambassador, announced April 2026.

Dhoni's voice powers 'Be a Rakshak', school-zone safety and compensation-awareness campaigns.

"We already know what is going wrong. What we need now is more responsibility, more discipline, more respect for life."

MS Dhoni, at the National Road Safety Implementation Forum, IIT Delhi

AS SEEN IN THE PRESS



Hindustan Times, on our Pre-Hospital Care Primer.



ThePrint, on the NextMile ideathon finale.

Bloomberg

Deccan Herald

Economic Times

Fortune India

IndiaSpend

Scroll.in

The Wire

Times of India

Business Standard

The institutions around the work

As they appear in our working decks, engagement ranges from formal MoUs and written approvals to jury, mentoring and research collaboration.

AUTHORITIES & PUBLIC BODIES WE WORK WITH



UNIVERSITIES & INSTITUTES FIELDING AUDIT TEAMS



EXPERT & ECOSYSTEM PARTNERS



Plus: Jaipur Traffic Police & Gurugram Police (MoUs) · CPWD & district administrations · Bloomberg, Johns Hopkins, Centre for Green Mobility and PwC experts on juries and reviews.

A full-time team built for this work

Engineering, law, policy, product and field operations, under trustees who have led Indian road safety for a decade.



Amar Srivastava
President · Founder, Indian Road Safety Campaign · Member, National Road Safety Council



Deepanshu Gupta
Managing Trustee · Founder, IRSC · Global Youth Coalition for Road Safety



Gajendra Jangid
General Secretary · Co-founder, Cars24

THE FULL-TIME TEAM



Akhtar Hussain **Mission Lead**
IIT Delhi · ex-Bain · strategy, programmes, new initiatives, partnerships and product



Krishna Jain **Tech & Product**
Builds and runs Aasha, SATARK and the open public data platforms



Ishita Rathore **People & Culture**
Talent and hiring, volunteers, the 75+ intern engineering corps



Shipra Kushwaha **Creative (Graphic)**
Guides, comics and bilingual campaign material families actually read



Shubham Kumar **Policy & Advocacy**
NALSAR Hyderabad · programmes, policy advocacy, legal research, government relations



Aastha Shreeharsh **Development Communications**
HKUST · institutional communications, government relations



Yuvraj Yadav **Operations**
Field operations across 18 cities · works with police on SATARK and enforcement rollouts



Muskan Yadav **Programmes**
TISS · district programmes, Project Rakshak, infrastructure interventions, DRSC work



Rohan Sharma **Cause Marketing**
Awareness campaigns, digital advocacy, community mobilisation



Lovish **Creative (Video)**
Video explainers, ground-audit films and the YouTube channel

Plus 75+ engineering interns and 31 student audit teams.

In-house capabilities: road-engineering audits · legal & policy research · AI product development · district operations · behaviour-change communication

Advised by the people who built India's road safety practice



Prof. Geetam Tiwari, Board of Advisors

Professor Emerita & Chair, TRIP Centre, IIT Delhi · four decades of transport safety research



Piyush Tewari, Board of Advisors

Founder & CEO, SaveLIFE Foundation · Architect of the Good Samaritan Law · Zero-Fatality Corridors

JURY, MENTORS & REVIEWERS AROUND OUR WORK



Justice J.R. Midha

Delhi High Court (Retd.)



Abhay Damle

Ex-JS, MoRTH



Vaibhav Dange

Ex-Advisor, MoRTH



Dr. Maya Tandon

Sahayta Trust



R. Venkat Ratnam

Government of Punjab



Akhilesh Srivastava

ITS India · IRF



Aishwarya Raman

OMI Foundation



Neeraj Kumar

Tata AIG



R.S. Pandey

FICCI Road Safety



Dipak K. Dash

Times of India

Engaged through the National Road Safety Dialogue Series: Balraj Bhanot (ex-Chair, CMVR-TSC) · I.V. Rao (TERI; ex-Maruti Suzuki) · D.P. Saste (CIRT / ex-MoRTH) · Dr. Sushma Sagar (AIIMS Trauma) · Dr. S. Velmurugan (CSIR-CRRI), and jurors from OMI, NIUA, WRI, CII and Tata AIG.

Project Rakshak, in one sentence

Trained student teams, guided by senior road-safety experts, audit dangerous road locations, and Crashfree India walks each recommended fix through the road-owning authority until it is built.



Students audit

Teams from IITs, NITs and SPAs collect data on-site: traffic, conflicts, 900+ stakeholder surveys.



Experts verify

Mentors anchor every audit to IRC codes and MoRTH checklists before anything is proposed.



Authorities build

The fix goes to the PWD, corporation or NHAI in its own format, and we track it to completion.

Four phases each cohort: Research & problem identification → Stakeholder engagement & audits → Analysis & costed solutions → Reporting & authority engagement

Identification has outpaced rectification, **capacity is the constraint**

The knowledge exists; the pipeline that turns identified risk into completed engineering needs more trained hands.

13,795

black spots identified nationally (MoRTH)

5,036

permanently rectified so far (Parliamentary Standing Committee, 2024)

20–80%

crash reduction where low-cost engineering fixes are applied (iRAP & PIARC)

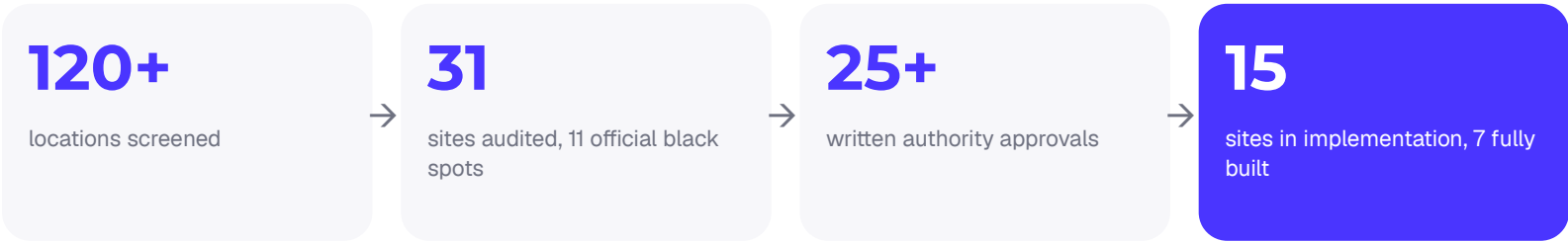
Raised crossings, traffic calming, lighting and safer intersections are proven, affordable counter-measures. What limits progress is steady, supervised auditing capacity and follow-through, working under the road-owning authority.

Project Rakshak was designed for precisely this constraint: trained auditing capacity that supports road-owning agencies, and tracks every fix to completion.



Audit findings on the executive engineer's desk, the road-owning authority acts.

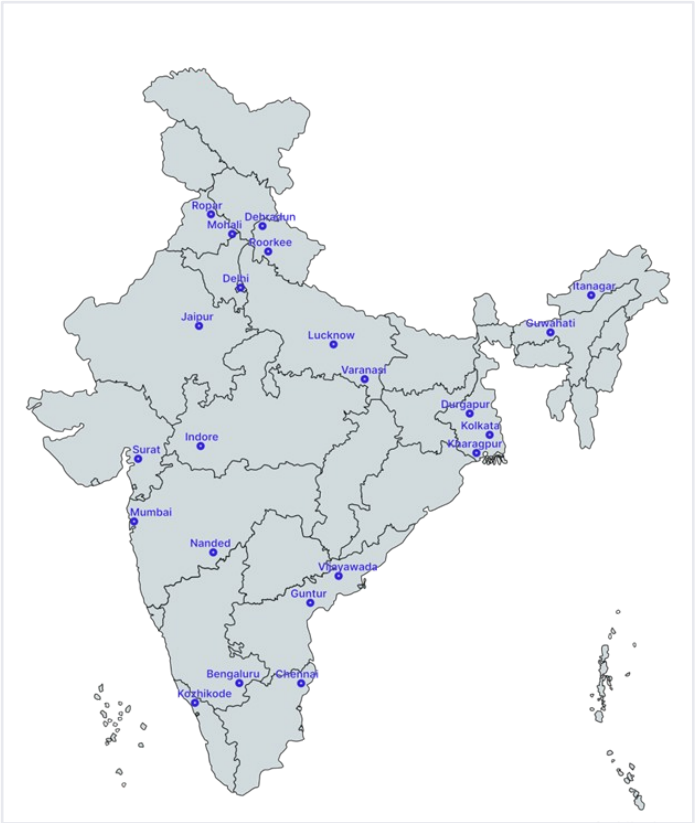
Cohort 1: a national footprint, now delivering



31 student teams · 20 institutions including nine IITs · 900+ stakeholder surveys · 17 subject-matter experts guiding and reviewing every audit

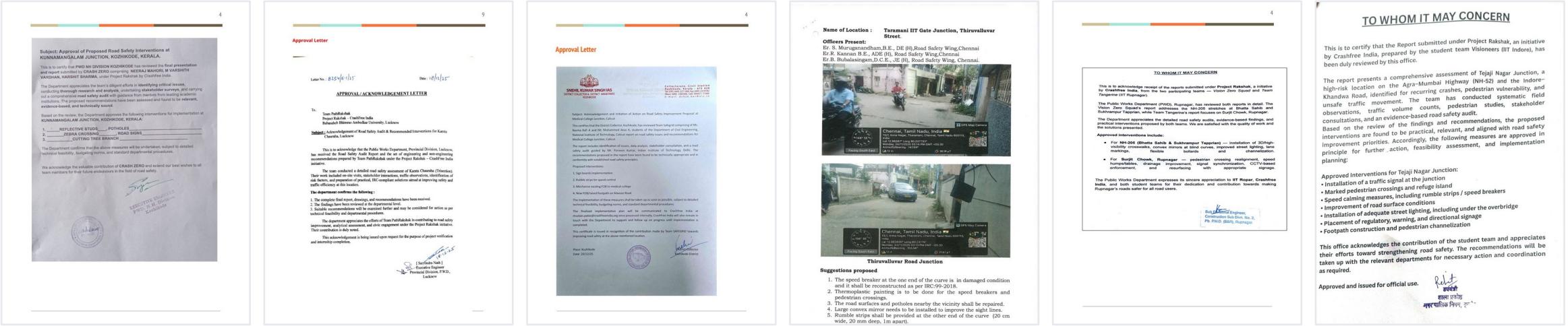
North: Ropar, Dehradun, Roorkee, Delhi, Lucknow, Varanasi · East: Guwahati, Durgapur · West & Central: Indore, Mumbai, Surat · South: Vijayawada, Guntur, Kozhikode, Chennai, among 18 cities.

Estimated 20–50% crash reduction at treated sites once complete, based on WHO / iRAP evidence for these counter-measures; we will verify with before-and-after data as implementations finish.



Cohort-1 sites across India.

Approvals in writing, from the authorities that own the roads



A sample of the 25+ approval and acknowledgement letters issued by public works and district authorities.

APPROVING AUTHORITIES INCLUDE

PWD Kerala

PWD Uttar Pradesh

PWD Punjab

CPWD + Addl. Collector, Indore

ADDA Durgapur

R&B Andhra Pradesh

GCC Chennai

BMC Mumbai

From approval to construction, and to completion

Live status from our public implementation tracker, August 2026.



Parking rationalisation, Durgapur



Fresh markings, Guntur



Footpath construction, Indore



Signage, Mumbai

7 sites fully implemented

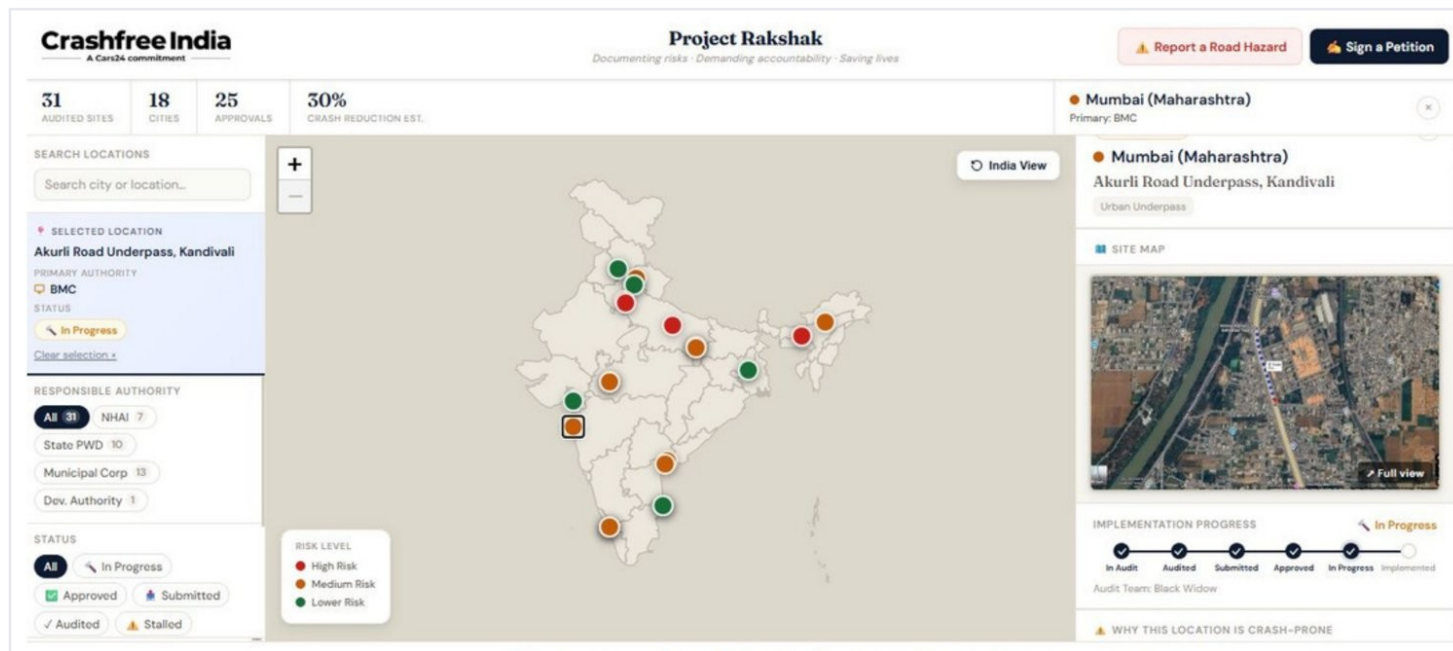
Outer Ring Road (Delhi) · IIT Madras Taramani Gate (Chennai) · Dafi Toll Plaza (Varanasi) · Akurli Road Underpass (Mumbai) · C-49 Commercial Area (Durgapur) · Chuttugunta Circle (Guntur) · Rau Gol Square (Indore)

6 more partially implemented : Kunnamangalam & Chevayur (Kozhikode), TIDEL Park (Chennai), Shivpur (Varanasi), Tejaji Nagar (Indore), Civil Lines (Roorkee); action initiated at further sites.

MARQUEE CASE, OUTER RING ROAD, SOUTH DELHI

On our audit, PWD built a continuous 1.8 m accessible pedestrian corridor, upgraded drainage at ponding sites, installed bollards against footpath encroachment, and deployed camera-backed speed-feedback boards.

A public dashboard tracks every site to completion



Live public dashboard, every site, its authority, risk level and implementation stage.



Every site tracked

From submission through approval to completed construction, regardless of who audited it.



The PRAGATI parallel

The PM's PRAGATI platform showed what visible follow-up does for stuck projects. Same principle here, for road safety fixes.



What the Board gains

An honest, live read on how quickly road-owning agencies can act, evidence for capacity planning, not just compliance.

Anchored to the codes **your engineers already use**



IRC codes & MoRTH checklists

Every audit instrument is built on them, nothing bespoke, nothing incompatible.



Expert review at every step

Prof. Geetam Tiwari (TRIP Centre, IIT Delhi) chairs our advisory work; every instrument is expert-reviewed before field use.



Masterclasses before fieldwork

Prof. Tiwari on the Safe System approach; Dr. S. Velmurugan (CSIR-CRRI) on IRC-131 and SP-55.



Handover in the authority's format

Findings arrive as the PWD or corporation needs them, ready to action, tracked publicly after.



Authority engagement is continuous, audit teams present to the engineers who own the road.



Seventeen experts work with us on infrastructure improvement

Academics and practitioners who guide the student teams through fieldwork and independently review every audit before it reaches an authority.

AK Amandeep Kumar Urban Transport Planner, KPMG	AB Dr. AVA Bharat Kumar Asst Prof., Vignan University	AS Asha SVT Ph.D. Scholar, IIT Delhi	PK Parveen Kumar Ph.D., IIT Delhi	RK Rashmeet Kaur Ph.D., IIT Delhi	RK Rajat Kalsi Road Safety Expert
PA Priyanshu Aman Ph.D., IIT Delhi	MN Mehraab Nazir Ph.D., IIT Delhi	HK Dr. Hemant Kumar Suman Asst Prof., CTRANS, IIT Roorkee	SS Dr. Shriniwas S Arkatkar Professor, SVNIT Surat	SP Dr. Sandeep Peeke Asst Prof., SPA Vijayawada	PK Dr. Purnima K Chowdhury Asst Prof., SPA Bhopal
AB Dr. Anshu Bamney Asst Prof., IIT Mandi	VS V. Sai Sesidhar Ph.D., IIT Kharagpur	AS Ashish Shrivastava Engineer, Traffic & Transport Planning	MS Mridul Sharotary Planner, EY	KK Kushal Khivansara TRIP Centre, IIT Delhi	

From IIT Delhi, IIT Roorkee, IIT Mandi, IIT Kharagpur, SVNIT, SPA Vijayawada, SPA Bhopal, Vignan University, KPMG and EY , the same mix of academia and practice the Working Group draws on.

Built to be institutionalised: not built to depend on us

Three audit tracks matched to road types, and a role for CFI that narrows over time.

Track A, Institutional	Track B, NGO partners	Track C, Certified RSAs
IIT / NIT / SPA teams under expert mentors	Field teams; desk-reviewed and re-verified by CFI	CSIR-CRRI-certified auditors, full IRC SP-88
Urban arterials, in-town state highways, district roads	District & peri-urban corridors	National highways, complex junctions

Today	CFI runs cohorts, quality-controls audits and stewards the public portal.
Next	Rakshak Audit Manual v1.0 codifies the method; universities field their own teams; NGOs run Track B directly.
Mature	States engage certified RSAs for Track C without CFI as intermediary; the portal remains the shared public record.

A growing evidence base on those most at risk

Roughly 70% of India's road crash fatalities are vulnerable road users, pedestrians, motorcyclists, bicyclists.

OUR PUBLISHED STUDY: 'WHEN RISKS BECOME ROUTINE' (FEB 2026)

~45%

of India's crash fatalities are two-wheeler users, rising year on year

1 in 2

delivery riders in a 431-rider Mumbai crash study had already crashed

~70%

of families at our crash-compensation helpdesks are vulnerable road users

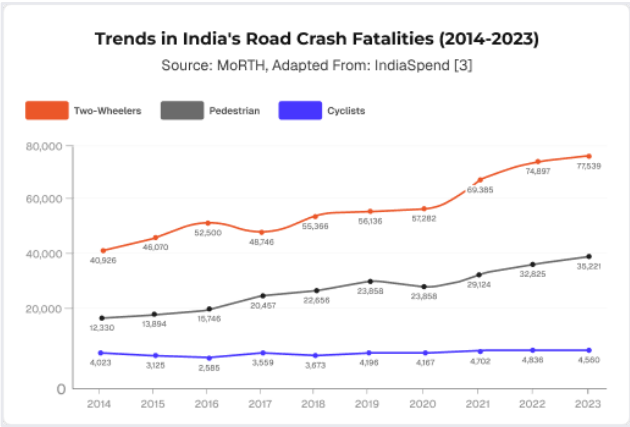
Forty pages and 87 references, published February 2026. Enforcement sees the risk too: Bengaluru's challans against delivery riders rose from 30,968 in 2023 to 63,718 in nine months of 2025. The study lands on two first levers, rider training and helmet compliance, and has been shared with platforms and police.

- Pedestrian-first audits**

Every Rakshak audit documents crossings, footpaths and lighting as designable protections, 900+ stakeholders consulted.
- School zones**

College-led, standards-based school-zone screening under exploration as the next extension of the audit platform.
- Enforcement that protects VRUs**

SATARK helps police prioritise the small share of vehicles with the worst records, targeted, fair, technology-led.



Fatality trends by road-user type, 2014–2023 (MoRTH; via IndiaSpend).



Four concrete offers to Working Group 2

All four are ready today, need no funding from the Board, and can begin within weeks.

- 1

Ready evidence for standard-setting

Site-level audit data, crash-pattern analysis and costed intervention designs across emerging hotspots and official black spots, for rectification protocols and speed-management guidance.
- 2

A live testing ground

Active district relationships in Gurugram, South-West Delhi and Jaipur offer a ready pipeline to pilot or stress-test draft recommendations before national rollout.
- 3

Ground-level implementation diagnostics

Granular, field-verified insight into how DRSCs and road-owning agencies actually move, meeting cadence, data use, follow-through.
- 4

Technical bench strength on request

Our academic and expert network stands ready for drafting, review and technical input on road design, speed and VRU standards.

We would be honoured to contribute to Working Group 2.

Our evidence, our district relationships, our technology and our expert bench are available to the Board, in whichever form is most useful.

"We already know what is going wrong. What we need now is more responsibility, more discipline, more respect for life."

MS Dhoni · Goodwill Ambassador, Crashfree India



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